Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 10 4
♥ K Q 9
♦ A 10 7
♣ Q J 9 7

♠ 7 5
♥ J 10 5 2
♦ Q J 5 4
♣ K 6 3

♠ Q J 9 6 3
♥ A 6 4
♦ 8 6 3
♣ 8 2

♠ A 8 2
♥ 8 7 3
♦ K 9 2
♣ A 10 5 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North
Lead: ♠Q

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠Q, the top of a broken honor sequence.

The top of a solid 3-card honor sequence is best, but as you can see, a broken 3-card sequence may work out just as good.

North will likely try the ♣ finesse, and when West wins the ♣K he will return a ♠ through North's ♠10.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K J 7 2 ♥ K J 10 3 2 ♦ 7 ♣ A 7 4	
♠ 9 4 3 ♥ 9 6 4 ♦ A Q 10 8 ♣ 9 8 3		♠ 8 5 ♥ A Q 8 5 ♦ 5 4 3 ♣ Q J 10 2
	♠ A Q 10 6 ♥ 7 ♦ K J 9 6 2 ♣ K 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♠3

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♠

Lead any ♠.

You have ♦ winners, but dummy will surely be short since he has at least 8 cards in the Major suits.

Partner has whatever ♥ strength your side possesses.

It is very likely that declarer will want to do some cross-trumping. To try to cut that down your best lead is a trump.

Just imagine that declarer wins the first ♠ in his hand and plays a ♥ to dummy's honors. East will win and play another trump. Whenever you win your first ♦ you will play your last trump.

As you can imagine, declarer will be in a whole lot of trouble.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A Q 6 ♥ A Q 9 ♦ A 10 7 ♣ K Q 7 3	
♠ 10 5 ♥ J 10 4 2 ♦ 9 6 5 4 3 ♣ J 9	N W E S	♠ K J 9 4 3 ♥ 6 5 3 ♦ 8 2 ♣ 10 6 2
	♠ 8 7 2 ♥ K 8 7 ♦ K Q J ♣ A 8 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♥6

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♥6.

You held this identical hand in Deal 3. The declarer was playing 3NT and the best lead was the ♠4, fourth down.

It's different when the conract is 6NT. Against 6NT you should make a passive lead, which means don't underlead any honors. Against 6NT you have little chance of establishing a suit to win four or five tricks. Instead, you just want to try to not give declarer an undeserved trick.

So any passive lead would be OK, you pick the ♥ just because they are less likely to have an unbid 4-card Major in either hand.

Declarer has 11 winners sitting there; if you had led a low ♠ you would have handed him his 12 trick on a platter.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 2
♥ A 9 7
♦ 10 5 3
♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ K 8 5 4
♥ 8 6 5 2
♦ K 6 2
♣ 10 2

♠ Q 9 7 6 3
♥ 10 4 3
♦ 4
♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ J 10
♥ K Q J
♦ A Q J 9 8 7
♣ J 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	2♣	Pass	3♦
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♦		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♦ by South
Lead: ♠4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6♦

Lead the ♠4.

Against a notrump slam it is best to make a passive lead so you don't give declarer an undeserved winner.

Against a suit slam the situation is very different. Against strong dummy bidding like this you are pretty sure that if you don't establish a winner early declarer will find something in dummy to discard losers on. In this hand it is dummy's ♣ suit.

Your most promising suit is ♠s. Obviously partner has a very weak hand, but if he has the ♠Q you can set up your ♠K before your King of trumps is dislodged.

Without a ♠ lead declarer will have smooth sailing.